

15.1 Movie Clips

“What kind of movie clips do I add to my presentation” is not something we can answer here; look back to chapter 2 for a couple of ideas. The fact is, you can make a presentation prettier *and* more utilitarian by adding a clip here and there. The only rule is to keep them short, or rather, to strive for that balance between how long the clips are and how long the presentation is.

If it's going to be the launch of a new product, you could include a message from the chairman or president—in the right measure; if it's a wildlife documentary, you could start off by lightening the mood with one of those silly monkey e-mail forwards you've received.

So why are we talking about inserting clips into a presentation? Why not just play the clip when you need to?

Good question, but the answers are easy. For one, it's clumsy: if you're using a wireless mouse to do the slide transitions, you'd have to expose your Desktop for a clip. Secondly, the possibilities open up with the idea that the clip can be of a screen size you choose, at a position you choose. Think about it. Your message would be very different if the chairman's address in your slide were to be at the corner of the screen, at 200 x 200, while the slides advanced as he spoke—than if the slide stood still while he spoke, at the centre of the screen, 500 x 500. It would be different, again, if there were to be no slide at all for a while, with the chairman's address put up full-screen.

If you were to package your presentation and send it to several people, you would have to insert the clip—you can't possibly send out directions: “at 11:32, play xyz.mpg.”

Now, clips in PowerPoint presentations can be in the form of video files (.MPG, .WMV, etc.) or Clip Art (such as GIF animations). You can choose Clip Art from the Clip Organizer—a library consisting of Clip Art, movie clips, sound clips, and images that get installed while you install Office (and others that it finds on your computer).